

Finding Our Inner Voice - Story Image Spread Review Pass 01

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Purpose: colleague-facing review artifact for the 31-page expanded working structure.

Status: main narrative imagery descriptions are directionally complete for pages 4-28. Front matter and end matter are included for context.

Front: Page 1

Page 1: Title

Story Text

Finding Our Inner Voice

Image Direction

Title page treatment. Quiet, magical, and clean, with subtle star/heart/inner-voice motif. No child pose needed.

Spread: Pages 2-3

Page 2: Blank

Story Text

Blank page.

Image Direction

Blank page to place dedication on a right-hand page. No art needed.

Page 3: Dedication

Story Text

Personalized dedication.

Image Direction

Use/refine existing dedication treatment. No child pose needed.

Spread: Pages 4-5

Page 4: Park Arrival

Story Text

This was [Child Name]’s favorite park in all of [Hometown].

Swings squeaked. Sneakers thumped. Kids laughed and called, “Again, again!”

[Child Name] ran in, ready to play.

Image Direction

Personalized child runs into a lively warm park. Child should be clear foreground hero. Swings/kids/path in scene; tall slide small or distant. New joyful park-arrival pose.

Page 5: Park Choices

Story Text

There were swings, tunnels, sand, and a climbing wall that looked almost like a mountain.

[Child Name] looked left. [Child Name] looked right.

“What should I try first?”

Then came a whoosh from way up high.

Image Direction

Wide park activity view with swings, tunnels, sand, climbing wall, and partially visible tall slide. Child optional; no new pose. Slide hint should visually support the whoosh.

Spread: Pages 6-7

Page 6: Tall Slide

Story Text

It was the tall slide.

Kids climbed up. Kids sat down. Kids whooshed all the way to the bottom.

“Again, again!” they shouted.

[Child Name] looked up.

The slide looked fun. It also looked very, very tall.

Image Direction

Ground-level tall-slide image. Kids clearly having fun. Child foreground/lower-midground looking up with mixed excitement and uncertainty. New looking-up pose.

Page 7: Top Overwhelm

Story Text

[Child Name] climbed to the top.

From up there, the slide looked longer than it did from the ground.

“Your turn!” “Go!” “It’s fun!”

[Child Name]’s tummy flipped. The top felt small. The slide felt big.

[Child Name] did not know what to do.

Image Direction

POV/no-child view from top of slide looking down a long slide. Park/kids far below. Friendly speech energy around platform. Big but not traumatic. No child pose.

Spread: Pages 8-9

Page 8: Bedtime Remembering

Story Text

That night, [Child Name] sat quietly on the bed.

The slide was far away now. But the big feeling was still there.

In bed, [Child Name] remembered the top. The long way down. The loud voices. The not-knowing-what-to-do feeling.

Image Direction

Medium-close cozy bedroom portrait at night. Child sitting quietly on the bed, visible and personalized, likely still in the standard hero outfit. Frame close enough to read expression and body language. Use simplified bed, pillow, wall glow, and optionally a loose lap blanket to signal bedtime without hiding the child. Faint memory echoes; subtle dim animal picture on wall.

Page 9: Tiny Voice

Story Text

“Your turn!” “Go!” “It’s fun!”

The voices bounced around in [Child Name]’s mind.

[Child Name] took a deep breath. The room got quiet.

Then [Child Name] heard something tiny.

“That was scary,” said the tiny voice.

[Child Name] nodded.

“Yes.”

“Oh!” said the tiny voice. “You can hear me now.”

Image Direction

Same bedroom or close crop. Remembered voices soften; tiny warm glow/voice appears near bed/window/floor. Reuse page 8 pose/base; no second new pose.

Spread: Pages 10-11

Page 10: Lights Begin

Story Text

“Who said that?” asked [Child Name].

A tiny light blinked beside the bed. Then another. Then another.

The lights made a little path across the floor.

“Let’s look together,” said the tiny voice.

Image Direction

Left half of one unified pages 10-11 spread image. Bedroom continuity; tiny lights form a path from the bed across the floor toward the gutter. Child now walking/following lights near the spread transition. New walking/following pose shared with page 11.

Page 11: Bedroom Transforms

Story Text

[Child Name] followed the little lights.

The bedroom grew soft at the edges. The walls became trees. The rug became moss. The ceiling filled with stars.

“This way,” said the tiny voice. “Whenever you’re ready.”

Image Direction

Right half of the same unified pages 10-11 spread image. The light trail continues from page 10 across the gutter. The bedroom is still visible at the left edge, then gently transforms into forest: walls to trees, rug to moss, ceiling to stars. Safe magical transition, not a hard doorway. Avoid making this feel like a second separate scene or duplicated child moment.

Spread: Pages 12-13

Page 12: First Animal Clue

Story Text

The lights led [Child Name] onto a quiet path.

In the middle was a little clue: [animal clue].

[Child Name] looked left. [Child Name] looked right.

“Where are you?” called [Child Name].

Image Direction

Quiet dream path with readable animal-specific clue: pawprints, dino prints, feathers, or tufts. Child looking around. Reuse walking/following pose if possible.

Page 13: Sneezing Bush

Story Text

Something rustled in a bush.

“Are you hiding?” asked [Child Name].

The bush rustled again.

Then it sneezed.

“Achoo!”

Bushes do not usually sneeze.

Image Direction

Funny rustling bush almost-reveal. Optional tiny clue such as tail tip, feather, sparkle, or footprint. Warm/playful, not suspenseful. No new pose.

Spread: Pages 14-15

Page 14: Playful Noise

Story Text

Before [Child Name] could peek behind the bush, the stars started blinking in every direction.

“This way!” blinked one. “No, this way!” puffed the wind. “Hop!” said a mushroom. “Skip!” said a stone.

Then a sign spun around and around.

“HURRY!” it pointed.

Image Direction

Object/sign-driven playful chaos: stars, wind, mushroom, stone, spinning sign, arrows. Busy and funny, not scary. No new pose.

Page 15: Quiet Path

Story Text

Every voice sounded sure. Every voice sounded busy.

[Child Name] turned this way. Then that way.

The tiny voice was hard to find.

“Listen close,” said the tiny voice. “I’m still here.”

[Child Name] listened extra close.

There it was: a quiet path.

Image Direction

Same noisy world resolving: chaos moves to edges while one calm quiet path/tiny warm light appears. Existing/listening pose optional; no new pose.

Spread: Pages 16-17

Page 16: Shiny Path

Story Text

The quiet path split in two.

One way was smooth and shiny. It looked easy.

The other way was plain and steep.

[Child Name] looked at the shiny path. It was pretty.

But something inside felt tight.

[Child Name] took a deep breath and listened.

“Not that way,” whispered the tiny voice.

Image Direction

Clear fork: shiny/easy path appealing but not evil; plain steep path quiet and stable. Tiny warm voice motif near plain path. No new pose.

Page 17: Path To Cave

Story Text

[Child Name] chose the steep path.

The path climbed up, and up, and up.

At the top was a cave.

The cave glittered inside. [Child Name] stepped closer.

Image Direction

Steep dream path climbing toward glittering cave entrance. Mysterious but not horror-scary. Small child optional; reuse walking/following pose if shown.

Spread: Pages 18-19

Page 18: Mean Words

Story Text

A wall blocked the path.

On it were big, prickly words:

YOU CAN'T! YOU'RE TOO LITTLE!

The friendly voice sounded different now.

“YOU CAN'T! YOU CAN'T!” it echoed through the cave.

“Why do you sound mean?” asked [Child Name].

Image Direction

Glittering cave wall blocking path with large harsh words. Words sharp/rough but not terrifying. Wall/text is focus; small child optional. No new pose.

Page 19: Words Soften

Story Text

The voice did not answer right away.

[Child Name] remembered what helped before.

One deep breath, then another.

The cave grew quieter.

The prickly words began to wiggle. Then soften.

Image Direction

Same cave wall calmer. Words wiggle, loosen, soften after breathing/listening. Warm breath/voice glow. Environment-led transformation; no new pose.

Spread: Pages 20-21

Page 20: Fear Inside

Story Text

The words opened.

Inside were smaller words:

I'M A LITTLE SCARED.

THIS FEELS TOO BIG.

“Oh,” said [Child Name]. “You were not trying to be mean.”

The tiny voice felt warm again.

Image Direction

Big harsh words open like shells/flaps/knots to reveal softer words inside. Warm glow returns. Clear cave word-wall metaphor. No new pose.

Page 21: Cave Lesson

Story Text

“Sometimes big feelings come out sharp,” said the voice.

“But if you listen close, you can hear what they are really trying to say.”

Image Direction

Calm cave with softened words glowing or drifting. Quiet visual so lesson has room. Existing calm/listening pose optional; no new pose.

Spread: Pages 22-23

Page 22: Cave Opens

Story Text

The prickles fell away. The wall shimmered. The cave opened wide.

Beyond it, the world was bright.

[Child Name] stepped through.

Image Direction

Cave opens into warm bright world; harsh pieces dissolve. Understanding softens the wall rather than breaking it. Small child optional; reuse walking pose if shown.

Page 23: Sunlight Understanding

Story Text

[Child Name] stepped into the sunlight.

The tight feeling was not so tight now.

[Child Name] knew what the tiny voice was for.

It helped [object pronoun] know what felt scary, what felt wrong, and what felt right.

When [Child Name] listened close, the big feeling did not feel so big.

Image Direction

Bright open sunlight after cave. Child calm/reflective, feeling lighter. Subtle warm glow around child; no animal reveal yet. No new pose.

Spread: Pages 24-25

Page 24: Last Clues

Story Text

“I want to see you,” said [Child Name].

A trail of [animal clues] glowed ahead.

[Child Name] followed them deeper into the magical forest.

The forest grew warmer. The path grew quieter.

“Where did you go?” whispered [Child Name].

“Listen close,” said the tiny voice. “That quiet is your heart.”

Image Direction

Warm golden forest path with animal-specific clues leading toward clearing/light. Strong candidate for existing almost-there forest/path asset with clue overlays. No new pose.

Page 25: Animal Reveal

Story Text

[Child Name] came to a clearing.

Warm magic swirled through the air.

[animal guide] appeared.

[Child Name] gasped.

“It was you?”

[animal guide] smiled.

“I am the quiet voice inside you,” said [animal guide], “in a shape you can see.”

The warm quiet was inside [Child Name], too.

Image Direction

Animal guide appears from warm magic swirls/cloud-like light. Reuse existing animal reveal image and selected animal overlay/sprite. Child reaction optional; no new pose.

Spread: Pages 26-27

Page 26: Flying Return

Story Text

The dream lifted.

[Child Name] and [animal guide] flew through the stars.

Below them, the magical forest grew small.

Ahead was the park, the ladder, and the very, very tall slide.

[animal guide] stayed close.

So did the quiet voice.

Image Direction

Reuse existing flying-home scene with child and animal. Add subtle park/slide destination cue if feasible. Reuse flying pose; no new pose.

Page 27: Slide Return

Story Text

[Child Name] was back at the top.

The slide still looked long. The slide still looked fun. The slide still looked very, very tall.

“Your turn!” “Go!” “It’s fun!”

[Child Name]’s tummy flipped.

This time, [Child Name] knew what to do.

Pause. Breathe. Listen close.

Image Direction

Mirror page 7: top-of-slide POV looking down, but calmer with more breathing space and subtle warm inner-voice motif. No child pose.

Spread: Pages 28-29

Page 28: Confident Choice

Story Text

The quiet voice was there.

Small and warm.

“Not yet,” it said. “Almost.”

[Child Name] looked at the child waiting behind [object pronoun].

“You go first,” said [Child Name]. “I’m almost ready.”

And this time, [Child Name] smiled.

Image Direction

Narrative ending. Slide platform/top side view with child calm, steady, and personalized; another child nearby but not dominant. New calm-speaking / steady-at-top pose.

Page 29: Blank Pause

Story Text

Blank page.

Image Direction

Blank or nearly blank page. Gives narrative ending breathing room before exercise. No pose.

Spread: Pages 30-31

Page 30: Spiral Exercise

Story Text

Pause. Breathe. Listen close.

Trace the spiral with your finger.

Breathe in as you go around. Breathe out as you come back.

Then ask inside:

Is there a tiny no? A not yet? A little yes?

Image Direction

Child-facing spiral breathing/listening exercise. Simple traceable spiral and quiet warm motif. No pose.

Page 31: About / Copyright

Story Text

About Little Hero Labs / copyright page.

Possible parent prompt:

Can you remember a tiny no, a not yet, or a little yes?

Image Direction

Quiet brand/copyright page with restrained Little Hero Labs presence and optional parent prompt. No pose.